Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Place-name detectives

Relief lesson · all levels. Use the word parts to decode the names.

Kupu / Word bank: wai = water · roto = lake · maunga = mountain · motu = island · awa = river · nui = big · iti = small · roa = long · tapu = sacred · wera = hot · one = sand, beach · puke = hill · whanga = harbour, bay

Part A · Decode the place names.

Place name	Parts	Meaning
Waiwera		
Rotoiti		
Whanganui		
Maunganui		
Motutapu		
Puketapu		
Oneroa		

Part B · Which island? Tick Te Ika-a-Māui (North) or Te Waipounamu (South).

Place	Te Ika-a-Māui	Te Waipounamu
Rotorua		
Kaikōura		
Taupō		
Ōtautahi		
Whanganui		
Aoraki		

Ara 1 · Write the te reo word.

1. water _____
2. lake _____
3. mountain _____
4. island _____
5. big _____
6. small _____
7. hot _____

Ara 2 · Sentence starters

- *Kei Te Ika-a-Māui a Rotorua. (Rotorua is in the North Island.)*
- *Kei Te Waipounamu a Kaikōura. (Kaikōura is in the South Island.)*
- *He roto nui a Taupō. (Taupō is a big lake.)*

Ara 2 · Write three sentences in te reo about places in Aotearoa, using the starters.

Ara 3 · Invent a te reo name for a place at school (the field, library, canteen …) using the word parts. Explain it in te reo: Ko … te ingoa, nā te mea he …

Everyone: design an imaginary island. Draw it and give six places te reo names made from the word parts (e.g. Rotoroa = long lake).

Finished early? *Write the English meaning beside each of your island names · Find three more Māori place names you know and try to decode them · Write a sentence about your island: He motu ātaahua a …*